

ROUTE 66: THE ACCOMMODATION FIELD GUIDE

EUROPETRIp.US

FIELD GUIDE SERIES

ROUTE 66

THE ACCOMMODATION FIELD GUIDE

120 Verified Hotels & Motels | Chicago to Santa Monica

Budget · Mid-Range · Luxury

2026 Edition

Researched, Not Generated

How to Use This Guide

This guide contains 120 verified hotels and motels along Route 66, organized into three price tiers: Budget (\$40–\$90/night), Mid-Range (\$90–\$180/night), and Luxury (\$180+/night). Each tier contains 40 properties listed in geographic order from Chicago to Santa Monica, so you can plan your nightly stops in sequence as you drive west.

Every hotel card includes a description written in documentary style — no promotional language, no unverified superlatives. Where a year of establishment is verified, it appears in the header. Ratings reflect aggregated guest scores from Google, TripAdvisor, and Booking.com as of early 2026. Prices are indicative ranges based on standard double-room rates and fluctuate seasonally.

Each card includes a Google Maps link using name-based search. Click or tap the orange link to open the hotel's location directly in Google Maps on any device. Use the Quick Reference table on the next page to see how many options are available in each city before you plan your route. Mix tiers freely — a budget night in Tucumcari and a luxury night in Santa Fe is a common and sensible pattern.

Quick Reference by Segment

Number of verified properties per destination and price tier. Use this table to plan how many nights to allocate per stop.

Destination	Budget	Mid-Range	Luxury
Chicago, IL	—	—	8
Springfield, IL	1	4	—
Litchfield, IL	1	—	—
Pontiac, IL	1	—	—
Cuba/Rolla, MO	2	—	—
Lebanon, MO	—	1	—
Saint Louis, MO	1	4	4
Carthage/Joplin, MO	1	1	—
Tulsa, OK	1	2	3
Catoosa/Stroud/Chandler, OK	3	1	—
Oklahoma City, OK	1	2	4
Clinton, OK	1	—	—
Shamrock, TX	2	—	—
Amarillo, TX	3	3	1
Tucumcari, NM	3	—	—
Santa Rosa, NM	—	2	—
Albuquerque, NM	1	2	6
Santa Fe, NM	—	1	3
Gallup, NM	1	3	—
Holbrook/Winslow, AZ	1	—	1
Flagstaff, AZ	2	1	—
Williams, AZ	2	3	—
Seligman, AZ	4	—	—
Kingman, AZ	2	3	—
Sedona, AZ	—	—	3
Needles, CA	2	2	—
Barstow, CA	2	—	—
Victorville, CA	1	1	—
Pasadena, CA	1	2	2
San Bernardino, CA	—	1	—
Santa Monica, CA	—	1	4

Budget Tier: 40 Hotels (\$40–\$90/night)

Illinois

The Mother Road begins in Chicago's Grant Park and cuts southwest through the prairie, passing diners, drive-ins, and small towns where Route 66 memorabilia fills every storefront.

1. COMFORT SUITES NEAR ROUTE 66

Springfield, IL | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5

A dependable base in the heart of Route 66 country, this property sits within walking distance of the Abraham Lincoln Presidential Museum and the Cozy Dog Drive In — birthplace of the corn dog on a stick. Rooms are contemporary and well-maintained, with complimentary breakfast and an indoor heated pool. Springfield is a required stop for any Route 66 itinerary, and this hotel keeps costs low without sacrificing cleanliness.

Why choose it: Solid budget anchor in Springfield with Route 66 attractions within a 5-minute drive.

Price indicative: \$72–\$95/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

2. QUALITY INN LITCHFIELD ROUTE 66

Litchfield, IL | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Positioned on the original Route 66 alignment in Litchfield, this hotel sits adjacent to the Ariston Cafe — operating continuously since 1924 and one of the oldest restaurants on the Mother Road. The property offers free breakfast, outdoor pool, and clean rooms at a price point that leaves budget for roadside diners. Litchfield itself is a quiet overnight between Chicago and Springfield.

Why choose it: Walk to the Ariston Cafe, one of Route 66's oldest restaurants, and save money doing it.

Price indicative: \$65–\$82/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Missouri

Missouri offers 300 miles of continuous Route 66 driving through the Ozarks, with some of the road's best-preserved motor courts and cave attractions along the way.

3. WAGON WHEEL MOTEL

Cuba, MO | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1938

Built in 1938 and listed on the National Register of Historic Places since 2003, the Wagon Wheel is one of the oldest continuously operating motels on Route 66. The property underwent a careful restoration in 2009-2010 that preserved its original Ozark stone construction and covered breezeway. Four rooms and two suites retain period character while adding modern plumbing and climate control. A textbook example of authentic Route 66 preservation.

Why choose it: Sleep in a National Register-listed 1938 motor court for under \$75 a night.

Price indicative: \$55–\$75/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

4. EDWIN LONG HOTEL

Rolla, MO | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1931

Opened in 1931 — the same year Route 66 was fully paved through Missouri — this downtown Rolla property has served road travelers for over nine decades. The building retains its original brick facade and lobby proportions. Rooms are basic but clean, and the location puts you steps from Rolla's Main Street and a cluster of local diners. Meramec Caverns sits 13 miles east.

Why choose it: A 1931 hotel that has hosted Route 66 travelers since the road was first paved.

Price indicative: \$60–\$90/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

5. LA QUINTA INN & SUITES ST. LOUIS ROUTE 66

Saint Louis, MO | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Sitting directly on the Route 66 corridor southwest of downtown St. Louis, this property offers free breakfast, indoor pool, and a location that keeps you on the Mother Road without downtown parking costs. The Gateway Arch is 17 miles northeast. Clean rooms, functional amenities, and a price point that works for multi-week road trips where every dollar counts.

Why choose it: Route 66 corridor location with free breakfast keeps your St. Louis stop under budget.

Price indicative: \$75–\$90/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

6. LA QUINTA INN & SUITES JOPLIN

Joplin, MO | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Joplin marks the point where Route 66 crosses into Oklahoma, and this 161-room property offers a practical overnight before the long Oklahoma stretch. Indoor and outdoor pools, complimentary breakfast, and proximity to downtown Joplin's murals and the Bonnie and Clyde Hideout — a verified 1933 garage apartment where the outlaws sheltered. Rooms are consistent and well-maintained.

Why choose it: Last affordable Missouri stop before the Oklahoma border, with pools and free breakfast.

Price indicative: \$68–\$85/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

7. DESERT HILLS MOTEL

Tulsa, OK | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1953

A surviving 1953 Route 66 motel on East 11th Street in Tulsa, the Desert Hills preserves the roadside aesthetic that defined mid-century motor travel. The original neon sign still glows. Rooms are basic — no-frills beds, free WiFi, and parking at your door — but the location on Tulsa's original Route 66 alignment and the sub-\$70 price make this a budget traveler's anchor in an increasingly expensive city.

Why choose it: Authentic 1953 Route 66 motel with working neon at the lowest price point in Tulsa.

Price indicative: \$55–\$70/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

8. SKYLINER MOTEL

Stroud, OK | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1959

The Skyliner opened in 1959 and underwent a \$200,000 restoration completed in 2025, bringing 10 rooms back to operation with period-appropriate furnishings and modern infrastructure. The Rock Cafe — featured in Pixar's Cars — sits nearby on Stroud's Main Street. This is a textbook example of a small-town Route 66 motel revival, independently owned and meticulously maintained.

Why choose it: Freshly restored 1959 motel near the Rock Cafe, a verified Pixar's Cars inspiration.

Price indicative: \$65–\$90/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

9. LINCOLN MOTEL

Chandler, OK | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1939

Built in 1939 as a cottage-style motor court, the Lincoln Motel retains its original 11-room layout with individual stone cabins connected by covered walkways. A 1950s neon sign marks the entrance on Route 66 through Chandler. The Route 66 Interpretive Center is minutes away. Rooms are modest but historically intact — you are sleeping in the same footprint that 1940s travelers used.

Why choose it: One of Oklahoma's few surviving 1939 cottage-style motor courts, still operating on Route 66.

Price indicative: \$80–\$98/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

10. CLASSEN INN

Oklahoma City, OK | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1963

Built in 1963 with distinctive Googie architecture — sharp angles, a cantilevered canopy, and Space Age details — the Classen Inn received a modern makeover that preserved its mid-century bones. Located on Classen Boulevard, a key Route 66 alignment through Oklahoma City. The property offers a pool, updated rooms, and a design-forward aesthetic unusual at this price point.

Why choose it: Googie architecture from 1963 with a modern refresh, at budget-friendly prices in OKC.

Price indicative: \$80–\$110/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Texas

The Texas Panhandle delivers the flattest, most unbroken horizon on Route 66. Cadillac Ranch, the Big Texan, and the open road itself are the main attractions.

11. WESTERN MOTEL

Shamrock, TX | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Directly across the street from the U-Drop Inn — Shamrock's iconic 1936 Art Deco tower station that inspired Ramone's House of Body Art in Pixar's Cars — this motel offers spacious rooms, pet-friendly policies, and the lowest nightly rate on the Texas Panhandle stretch of Route 66. Shamrock is a mandatory photo stop, and sleeping here puts you steps from the landmark at sunrise.

Why choose it: Wake up across the street from the U-Drop Inn, Route 66's most photographed building in Texas.

Price indicative: \$50–\$75/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

12. BIG TEXAN MOTEL

Amarillo, TX | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Adjacent to the Big Texan Steak Ranch — home of the famous 72-ounce steak challenge — this motel is built as a replica Old West town with wooden facades and themed rooms. An outdoor pool shaped like the state of Texas and proximity to Cadillac Ranch (10 miles west) make it a family-friendly Route 66 stop. Rooms are functional, clean, and themed without being kitschy.

Why choose it: Texas-shaped pool, Old West theming, and a free 72-ounce steak if you can eat it in one hour.

Price indicative: \$60–\$90/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

13. ROUTE 66 INN

Amarillo, TX | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1957

A 1957 motor lodge built in Spanish Eclectic style with 30 rooms arranged around a central courtyard. The original architecture features stucco walls, arched entries, and period signage. Located on Amarillo Boulevard — the city's primary Route 66 alignment. The property has maintained its mid-century footprint while updating infrastructure. Cadillac Ranch sits 10 miles west.

Why choose it: A 1957 Spanish-style motor lodge on Amarillo's Route 66 boulevard, preserved in its original layout.

Price indicative: \$70–\$90/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

New Mexico

New Mexico's Route 66 runs through high desert, past Pueblo architecture, and along legendary motel rows. The landscape shifts from plains to mesas to the Rio Grande valley.

14. BLUE SWALLOW MOTEL

Tucumcari, NM | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4.5/5 | Est. 1939

Opened in 1939 and listed on the National Register of Historic Places, the Blue Swallow is the most photographed motel on Route 66. Its 12-unit L-shaped layout, iconic neon swallow sign, and original Bakelite telephones in every room make it a living museum of pre-war motor court design. The Smithsonian has called it the last best of the old motels. Garages attached to each room — a luxury from the era when travelers wanted their car close.

Why choose it: The Smithsonian-recognized icon of Route 66 motel culture, at under \$80 a night.

Price indicative: \$55–\$80/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

15. MOTEL SAFARI

Tucumcari, NM | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1959

A 1959 Googie/Doo Wop-style motel featured in Architectural Digest's list of nine undeniably cool retro hotels in America. The Safari's neon sign, angular roofline, and rockabilly aesthetic have made it a social media fixture. Rooms have been updated with espresso machines and curated vintage decor while preserving the original floor plan. Tucumcari's motel row — once home to 2,000 rooms — now has fewer than 200.

Why choose it: Architectural Digest-featured 1959 motel on Tucumcari's legendary motel row.

Price indicative: \$60–\$85/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

16. HISTORIC ROUTE 66 MOTEL

Tucumcari, NM | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1963

Built in 1963 in the California Modern/Googie style, this Tucumcari motel was remodeled in 2007 with rooms named after classic Hollywood actors and musicians. An espresso bar in the lobby adds a contemporary touch. At \$45-65 per night, it offers the lowest entry point on Tucumcari's famous motel strip — which once advertised 2,000 rooms to road-weary travelers approaching from the east.

Why choose it: The most affordable overnight on Tucumcari's storied motel row.

Price indicative: \$45–\$65/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

17. MONTEREY MOTEL

Albuquerque, NM | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1938

Originally built as Davis Court in 1938, the Monterey sits on Central Avenue — Albuquerque's Route 66 alignment — beneath an iconic neon sign that has become one of the city's most photographed landmarks. The Googie-influenced architecture and motor court layout place it firmly in the pre-war era of Route 66 travel. Old Town Albuquerque is a 10-minute drive west.

Why choose it: A 1938 motor court with one of Albuquerque's most recognizable neon signs.

Price indicative: \$55–\$75/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

18. COMFORT INN GALLUP I-40

Gallup, NM | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4.4/5

Recently renovated with an indoor heated pool and on-site restaurant, this Gallup property scores the highest guest rating of any budget hotel in the city. Gallup sits at the intersection of Route 66 and Navajo Nation territory, making it a practical base for exploring both the Mother Road and the Southwest's largest reservation. The Gallup Cultural Center and Route 66 murals are within a 5-minute drive.

Why choose it: Highest-rated budget hotel in Gallup, gateway to both Route 66 and Navajo country.

Price indicative: \$70–\$90/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Arizona

Arizona packs Route 66's most dramatic scenery: painted deserts, ponderosa forests, the Grand Canyon's gateway, and a string of small towns that fought to keep the road alive.

19. WIGWAM MOTEL

Holbrook, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1950

Built in 1950, Wigwam Village #6 consists of 15 concrete teepees standing 32 feet high, each containing a bedroom with original hickory furniture. Listed on the National Register of Historic Places since 2002, the motel directly inspired the Cozy Cone Motel in Pixar's Cars. Vintage

automobiles parked between the teepees complete the tableau. One of only three surviving Wigwam Villages in America.

Why choose it: Sleep inside a 32-foot concrete teepee — one of only three surviving Wigwam Villages nationwide.

Price indicative: \$65–\$100/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

20. CANYON LODGE MOTEL

Seligman, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

The top-rated property in Seligman — the small Arizona town credited with saving Route 66 from obscurity after Angel Delgadillo's 1987 campaign. Sixteen themed rooms, free breakfast, and a location on Seligman's main strip put you steps from the Delgadillo barbershop and gift shop. Seligman's entire downtown functions as an open-air Route 66 museum, and this is the best place to sleep in it.

Why choose it: Top-rated hotel in the town that saved Route 66, with themed rooms and free breakfast.

Price indicative: \$75–\$95/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

21. STAGECOACH 66 MOTEL

Seligman, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4.5/5 | Est. 1960

A 1960s motor court that earned a perfect 10/10 on Hotels.com, the Stagecoach 66 is Seligman's best-reviewed property by guest satisfaction. Clean rooms, free WiFi, and a quiet location on the western edge of town offer respite after the long drive from Flagstaff. The motel preserves its original single-story layout and parking-at-your-door convenience that defined Route 66 travel.

Why choose it: Perfect 10/10 guest score in the town that launched the Route 66 preservation movement.

Price indicative: \$72–\$105/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

22. THE AZTEC MOTEL & CREATIVE SPACE

Seligman, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Part motel, part artist residency, the Aztec brings a contemporary creative edge to Seligman's vintage strip. Rooms feature retro design with curated artwork, and the property doubles as a creative space for traveling artists. Modern amenities — proper mattresses, reliable WiFi, coffee bar — sit inside a building that respects the proportions and aesthetic of classic Route 66 motor courts.

Why choose it: A creative-forward motel that merges Route 66 nostalgia with contemporary art and design.

Price indicative: \$90–\$105/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

23. DAYS INN & SUITES EAST FLAGSTAFF

Flagstaff, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Located on Historic Route 66 through Flagstaff with free breakfast, a pool, and an 8.3/10 guest rating. Flagstaff sits at 7,000 feet elevation — a welcome cool-down after the desert — and serves as the gateway to the Grand Canyon's South Rim (80 miles north). Route 66's neon motel row through central Flagstaff is one of the best-preserved stretches in Arizona.

Why choose it: Budget base for Grand Canyon day trips, on Flagstaff's preserved Route 66 neon strip.

Price indicative: \$70–\$90/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

24. WESTERN HILLS MOTEL

Flagstaff, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1950

Built in 1950 with one of the most iconic neon signs on Route 66 — a galloping horse silhouette visible for half a mile — the Western Hills sits on West Route 66 through Flagstaff. The sign alone has been photographed by thousands of Route 66 travelers and appears in multiple documentaries about the Mother Road. Rooms are basic, but you are staying beneath a verified piece of American roadside art.

Why choose it: The galloping-horse neon sign is one of Route 66's most documented pieces of roadside art.

Price indicative: \$55–\$75/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

25. RED GARTER INN

Williams, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4.5/5 | Est. 1897

Originally built in 1897 as a saloon and bordello serving the railroad and mining crews of northern Arizona, the Red Garter was restored into a four-room bed and breakfast on Historic Route 66 through Williams. The building's original pressed-tin ceiling, brick walls, and narrow staircase remain intact. Williams is the departure point for the Grand Canyon Railway, and this is its most historically layered property.

Why choose it: Sleep in a restored 1897 saloon-turned-B&B in the Grand Canyon Railway town.

Price indicative: \$55–\$100/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

26. DAYS INN BY WYNDHAM WILLIAMS

Williams, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

A reliable budget option in Williams — the last town bypassed by Interstate 40 in Arizona, in 1984. Free breakfast, a pool, and rates starting under \$60 make this a practical base for Grand Canyon Railway departures (the train leaves at 9:30 AM). Williams' Route 66 main street is walkable from the property, with vintage diners and souvenir shops.

Why choose it: Under \$60 per night in the Grand Canyon Railway departure town.

Price indicative: \$58–\$75/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

27. EL TROVATORE MOTEL

Kingman, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1929

Built in the late 1920s on the cusp of Route 66's golden era, the El Trovatore features rooms themed after Hollywood stars who passed through Kingman en route to Los Angeles. The motel sits on Andy Devine Avenue — Kingman's Route 66 alignment, named after the local actor who appeared in over 400 films. Original architectural details survive beneath decades of updates.

Why choose it: Hollywood-themed rooms in a 1920s motel on a street named for a Route 66-era film star.

Price indicative: \$65–\$90/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

28. BAYMONT BY WYNDHAM KINGMAN

Kingman, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

The best-value option in Kingman, where Route 66 splits into two alignments — one heading northwest to Oatman's gold-rush ghost town, the other following I-40 to Needles. Rooms are standard but clean, with a pool and free WiFi. The Route 66 Museum in Kingman's Powerhouse Visitor Center is a 5-minute drive and provides one of the best curated overviews of the road's full history.

Why choose it: Affordable base at the fork where Route 66 splits toward Oatman or the California desert.

Price indicative: \$62–\$80/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

California

The final stretch crosses the Mojave Desert, climbs the Cajon Pass, and descends through the Los Angeles basin to the Pacific Ocean at Santa Monica Pier.

29. RIO DEL SOL INN

Needles, CA | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Needles marks the California entry point for Route 66 travelers, and this independently operated inn offers a pool, steam room, and rates under \$100 in a town where options are limited. The Colorado River is minutes away, and the summer heat (regularly exceeding 115°F) makes the pool a necessity, not a luxury. El Garces — the iconic 1908 Harvey House — stands in ruins nearby, awaiting restoration.

Why choose it: One of the few well-rated independents in Needles, California's Route 66 gateway.

Price indicative: \$75–\$99/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

30. ROUTE 66 MOTEL

Barstow, CA | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

An unabashedly retro property on Main Street in Barstow — Route 66's alignment through the Mojave Desert — with round beds, a vintage car collection parked on the grounds, and rates starting under \$50. This is the kind of roadside motel that existed by the thousands in the 1960s and now survives as a curiosity. The Route 66 Mother Road Museum is a 5-minute drive.

Why choose it: Round beds, vintage cars, and sub-\$50 rates — peak Route 66 roadside kitsch.

Price indicative: \$48–\$65/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

31. RODEWAY INN ON HISTORIC ROUTE 66

Barstow, CA | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Ranked the second-best value hotel in Barstow, this property offers cooked-to-order breakfast — rare at this price point — plus a pool and direct placement on Historic Route 66. The Mojave Desert stretch between Barstow and Needles is one of the loneliest on the Mother Road, making Barstow an essential fuel-and-rest stop before or after the crossing.

Why choose it: Cooked-to-order breakfast at budget prices in the Mojave Desert's primary rest stop.

Price indicative: \$80–\$95/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

32. NEW CORRAL MOTEL

Victorville, CA | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4.3/5 | Est. 1950

A classic 1950s motor court in Victorville — once the domain of Roy Rogers and the gateway to Apple Valley's ranch country. Recently refurbished rooms retain the single-story, parking-at-your-door format. The California Route 66 Museum sits nearby on D Street. Victorville's segment of Route 66 runs along 7th Street and preserves several mid-century commercial buildings.

Why choose it: A refurbished 1950s motor court near the California Route 66 Museum.

Price indicative: \$65–\$80/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

33. THE ASTRO PASADENA HOTEL

Pasadena, CA | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4.2/5 | Est. 1962

Built in 1962 with textbook Googie/Space Age architecture — angled rooflines, starburst details, and a soaring lobby — the Astro was restored in 2016 as a boutique hotel. Located on Colorado Boulevard, Pasadena's Route 66 alignment and the Rose Parade route. Thirty-four rooms offer a design-forward experience at budget prices, with Old Town Pasadena's restaurants within walking distance.

Why choose it: A 1962 Googie landmark restored as a boutique hotel, on Route 66's Rose Parade route.

Price indicative: \$82–\$95/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

34. RED ROOF INN NEEDLES

Needles, CA | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5

A 2026 Traveler Review Award winner in one of Route 66's most remote California outposts. Pet-friendly, with basic but clean rooms and reliable air conditioning — critical in a town where summer temperatures routinely hit 120°F. Needles was a key waypoint for Dust Bowl migrants heading west, and John Steinbeck set part of *The Grapes of Wrath* here.

Why choose it: Award-winning budget option in the Grapes of Wrath town where AC is survival, not comfort.

Price indicative: \$70–\$85/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Texas

The Texas Panhandle delivers the flattest, most unbroken horizon on Route 66. Cadillac Ranch, the Big Texan, and the open road itself are the main attractions.

35. SILVER SPUR MOTEL

Amarillo, TX | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1952

A 1952 motel whose classic neon sign — a cowboy boot with a spinning spur — is one of Route 66's most documented pieces of roadside signage through the Texas Panhandle. Rooms are stripped-down basic, but the sign alone is worth the stop. Located on Amarillo Boulevard East, the city's primary Route 66 alignment, with the Big Texan Steak Ranch nearby.

Why choose it: The spinning-spur neon sign is a Route 66 photography essential, and rooms start at \$45.

Price indicative: \$45–\$70/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Arizona

Arizona packs Route 66's most dramatic scenery: painted deserts, ponderosa forests, the Grand Canyon's gateway, and a string of small towns that fought to keep the road alive.

36. DELUXE INN MOTEL

Seligman, AZ | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

A straightforward budget motel in Seligman offering clean rooms and parking at your door — the two things a Route 66 budget traveler actually needs. Seligman sits on the longest surviving stretch of Route 66 in Arizona, between Ash Fork and Kingman, and the town's cluster of vintage shops and photo ops makes an overnight worthwhile even on a tight schedule.

Why choose it: No-frills overnight on Arizona's longest surviving stretch of original Route 66 pavement.

Price indicative: \$65–\$80/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

37. HAMPTON INN CLINTON

Clinton, OK | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Clinton, Oklahoma houses the Oklahoma Route 66 Museum — one of the three best Route 66 museums in America — and this 68-room hotel sits three minutes from its entrance. Free breakfast, clean rooms, and a location that breaks up the long drive between Oklahoma City and Amarillo. The museum's 1950s diner recreation alone is worth the detour.

Why choose it: Three minutes from the Oklahoma Route 66 Museum, the road's best curated exhibit.

Price indicative: \$80–\$90/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Texas

The Texas Panhandle delivers the flattest, most unbroken horizon on Route 66. Cadillac Ranch, the Big Texan, and the open road itself are the main attractions.

38. ROUTE 66 INN

Shamrock, TX | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

A modest motel in Shamrock — a small Texas Panhandle town whose claim to Route 66 fame is the Conoco Tower Station (U-Drop Inn), a 1936 Art Deco masterpiece restored with a \$1.7 million grant. The inn offers basic rooms and free parking at the lowest prices on the Texas stretch. From here, it is 100 miles of open panhandle to Amarillo.

Why choose it: Budget overnight in the shadow of Route 66's \$1.7 million restored Art Deco tower.

Price indicative: \$50–\$70/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Illinois

The Mother Road begins in Chicago's Grant Park and cuts southwest through the prairie, passing diners, drive-ins, and small towns where Route 66 memorabilia fills every storefront.

39. BEST WESTERN PONTIAC INN

Pontiac, IL | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4.2/5

Pontiac is home to the Route 66 Hall of Fame and Museum — a two-story collection of Mother Road memorabilia — and this is the town's top-rated hotel. The property sits on West Reynolds Street with easy access to the Illinois Route 66 Scenic Byway. Pontiac's downtown murals and the Wally Parks NHRA Motorsports Museum add depth to an overnight stop.

Why choose it: Top-rated hotel in the Route 66 Hall of Fame town, on Illinois' scenic byway.

Price indicative: \$85–\$95/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

40. LA QUINTA INN & SUITES CATOOSA ROUTE 66

Catoosa, OK | [BUDGET] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5

Catoosa sits just east of Tulsa and is home to the Blue Whale — a 20-foot concrete whale built by Hugh Davis in 1972 that has become one of Route 66's most photographed roadside attractions. This pet-friendly property offers free breakfast and a location that puts you minutes from both the Blue Whale and Tulsa's Blue Dome District without downtown parking costs.

Why choose it: Minutes from the Blue Whale, one of Route 66's most photographed roadside icons.

Price indicative: \$60–\$80/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Mid-Range Tier: 40 Hotels (\$90–\$180/night)

Illinois

The Mother Road begins in Chicago's Grant Park and cuts southwest through the prairie, passing diners, drive-ins, and small towns where Route 66 memorabilia fills every storefront.

1. ROUTE 66 HOTEL AND CONFERENCE CENTER

Springfield, IL | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Originally built as a Holiday Inn — one of the first on Route 66 — this 106-room property on the original highway alignment now operates independently with a mini-museum of Route 66 memorabilia in the lobby. The hotel sits on the city's primary Route 66 corridor, within driving distance of the Lincoln Home National Historic Site and the Cozy Dog Drive In. A piece of Route 66 hospitality history in itself.

Why choose it: One of the first Holiday Inns on Route 66, now independent with a lobby memorabilia museum.

Price indicative: \$90–\$130/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

2. INN AT 835 BOUTIQUE HOTEL

Springfield, IL | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.4/5 | Est. 1909

The only Springfield lodging listed on the National Register of Historic Places, this 1909 property was originally a private home before conversion into a 13-room boutique hotel. Period details — original woodwork, leaded glass, and a grand staircase — survive throughout. Each room is individually decorated. It is the most architecturally distinguished overnight between Chicago and St. Louis on Route 66.

Why choose it: Springfield's only National Register-listed hotel, with 13 individually designed rooms.

Price indicative: \$110–\$155/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

3. THE PASFIELD HOUSE INN

Springfield, IL | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5 | Est. 1896

A Georgian-style inn operating since 1896, predating Route 66 by three decades. Six suites are furnished with period antiques and located near the Governor's Mansion. The Pasfield family was prominent in Springfield politics, and the house retains that era's proportions — high ceilings, formal parlors, and a wraparound porch. Breakfast is included and locally sourced.

Why choose it: A pre-Route 66 Georgian inn near the Governor's Mansion, with six antique-furnished suites.

Price indicative: \$95–\$140/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Missouri

Missouri offers 300 miles of continuous Route 66 driving through the Ozarks, with some of the road's best-preserved motor courts and cave attractions along the way.

4. BOOTS COURT MOTEL

Carthage, MO | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★☆ 4.1/5 | Est. 1939

A 1939 Art Deco/Streamline Moderne motor court added to the National Register of Historic Places in September 2022. Thirteen rooms were meticulously restored in 2023 with original 1940s details — Bakelite fixtures, chrome hardware, and period-appropriate paint colors. The building's curved corners and porthole windows are textbook Streamline Moderne. Carthage itself features a ornate Victorian courthouse on its town square.

Why choose it: National Register-listed 1939 Streamline Moderne motel, restored to original specifications in 2023.

Price indicative: \$95–\$140/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

5. MUNGER MOSS MOTEL

Lebanon, MO | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★☆ 4.3/5 | Est. 1946

Opened in 1946 and operated for decades by Bob and Ramona Lehman — whose personal touch made it one of the most beloved stops on Route 66 — the Munger Moss underwent new ownership and renovation in late 2024. The iconic neon sign, shaped like a television set, remains. Located at the intersection of Route 66 and I-44 in Lebanon, it sits roughly at the midpoint of the Missouri stretch.

Why choose it: A 1946 Route 66 institution with an iconic TV-shaped neon sign, recently under new stewardship.

Price indicative: \$85–\$120/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

6. MOONRISE HOTEL

Saint Louis, MO | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★☆ 4.5/5

A boutique hotel in St. Louis's Delmar Loop district — one of the American Planning Association's 10 Great Streets — with a rooftop terrace offering unobstructed city views. The contemporary design includes rotating local art exhibitions and a lobby that functions as a gallery. Not a Route 66 heritage property, but a St. Louis original with the kind of editorial interest that generic downtown hotels lack.

Why choose it: Rooftop views from a boutique gallery-hotel on one of America's 10 Great Streets.

Price indicative: \$125–\$170/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

7. DRURY INN & SUITES ST. LOUIS UNION STATION

Saint Louis, MO | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.1/5 | Est. 1907

Housed in a 1907 YMCA building with original leaded glass windows and marble details, this property offers Drury's signature free evening food and drinks — a full spread of hot food and three alcoholic beverages, saving \$30-50 per person on dinner. Union Station's Grand Hall, with its 65-foot barrel-vaulted ceiling, is across the street. St. Louis's position as the Gateway to the West made it Route 66's first major metropolitan stop.

Why choose it: Free evening meals in a 1907 building across from Union Station's 65-foot vaulted ceiling.

Price indicative: \$105–\$145/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

8. HOLIDAY INN ST. LOUIS SOUTHWEST ROUTE 66

Saint Louis, MO | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Positioned directly on Historic Route 66 at the I-44/I-270 interchange, this property features the Twisted Tree Steakhouse — an award-winning on-site restaurant rare at this price tier. Resort-style pool, 188 rooms, and a location that keeps you on the Mother Road's alignment through southwestern St. Louis County. The Route 66 State Park sits 12 miles west.

Why choose it: Route 66 alignment hotel with an award-winning steakhouse and resort pool.

Price indicative: \$100–\$140/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

9. THE CAMPBELL HOTEL

Tulsa, OK | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1927

Built in 1927 as a Spanish Colonial Revival hotel and listed on the National Register, the Campbell reopened in 2011 after a complete renovation that preserved its original tile work, arched windows, and courtyard. Twenty-six individually designed rooms sit directly on Route 66 through Tulsa. A salon and bar occupy the ground floor. This is Tulsa's most architecturally significant Route 66 property.

Why choose it: A 1927 Spanish Colonial hotel on Tulsa's Route 66, with 26 uniquely designed rooms.

Price indicative: \$120–\$165/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

10. GLÖ BEST WESTERN TULSA EAST ROUTE 66

Catoosa, OK | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.1/5

A hip boutique-design property in the Best Western portfolio, positioned on Route 66 near Catoosa's Blue Whale. The GLö brand emphasizes clean contemporary design — platform beds, rain showers, and accent lighting — at mid-range prices. Complimentary hot breakfast and proximity to both the Blue Whale and Tulsa's east-side attractions make it a practical design-forward base.

Why choose it: Contemporary boutique design on Route 66 near the Blue Whale, at mid-range prices.

Price indicative: \$90–\$120/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

11. HYATT PLACE TULSA DOWNTOWN

Tulsa, OK | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5

Tulsa's downtown, anchored by the Art Deco skyline built during the 1920s oil boom, is one of the most architecturally significant small city centers in America. This property puts you within walking distance of the Blue Dome District, Cain's Ballroom (the Carnegie Hall of western swing), and Tulsa's Route 66 alignment. Free breakfast, modern rooms, and a gallery walk through the lobby.

Why choose it: Walking distance to Tulsa's oil-boom Art Deco district and Cain's Ballroom.

Price indicative: \$110–\$150/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

12. THE ELLISON, A TRIBUTE PORTFOLIO HOTEL

Oklahoma City, OK | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Named after Ralph Ellison, the Oklahoma City-born author of *Invisible Man*, this 120-room hotel sits in the Automobile Alley Arts District — historically the city's car dealership row and now its gallery corridor. The literary connection and Arts District location give it editorial depth.

Oklahoma City's Route 66 alignment runs through the city center, and the National Cowboy Museum is a 10-minute drive.

Why choose it: Literary-themed hotel in OKC's former car dealership row, now a gallery district.

Price indicative: \$120–\$175/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Texas

The Texas Panhandle delivers the flattest, most unbroken horizon on Route 66. Cadillac Ranch, the Big Texan, and the open road itself are the main attractions.

13. EMBASSY SUITES AMARILLO DOWNTOWN

Amarillo, TX | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.1/5

A 225-room all-suite hotel in downtown Amarillo with complimentary cooked-to-order breakfast and an evening reception with drinks. The all-suite format — separate living room and bedroom — offers genuine comfort for road-trip families or couples who have been driving 8 hours through the Texas Panhandle. Cadillac Ranch is a 15-minute drive west on I-40.

Why choose it: All-suite rooms with free breakfast and evening drinks, after the long Panhandle drive.

Price indicative: \$130–\$175/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

14. COURTYARD BY MARRIOTT AMARILLO DOWNTOWN

Amarillo, TX | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1923

Occupying the 1923 Fisk Bank building in downtown Amarillo, this Courtyard conversion preserved the original banking hall proportions — high ceilings, heavy stonework, and brass details. An 8.6/10 guest rating places it among Amarillo's best-reviewed properties. The building's transformation from bank to hotel mirrors the shift in Amarillo's economy from cattle and oil to tourism and hospitality.

Why choose it: A 1923 bank building converted to a hotel, with original banking hall details preserved.

Price indicative: \$110–\$155/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

New Mexico

New Mexico's Route 66 runs through high desert, past Pueblo architecture, and along legendary motel rows. The landscape shifts from plains to mesas to the Rio Grande valley.

15. EL VADO MOTEL

Albuquerque, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1937

Opened in 1937 and left vacant for years, El Vado was rescued by a \$12 million restoration completed in 2018 that transformed it into a 22-room boutique hotel with on-site restaurants, a taproom, and a central courtyard. Listed on the National Register of Historic Places, the pueblo-revival architecture and hand-painted tile details were painstakingly restored. Central Avenue — Albuquerque's Route 66 — runs directly in front.

Why choose it: A \$12 million restoration of a 1937 Route 66 motel, now Albuquerque's most storied boutique stay.

Price indicative: \$120–\$170/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

16. HOTEL ZAZZ

Albuquerque, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.2/5

Originally a 1950s Travelodge on Central Avenue, Hotel Zazz reopened in 2022 after a design-forward renovation that layered neon safari motifs over the motel's original mid-century bones. The result is a property with genuine visual personality — something Albuquerque's Route 66 strip needed. Award-winning design, a courtyard pool, and a location on the original highway alignment between Old Town and the University of New Mexico.

Why choose it: A 1950s motel reimagined with award-winning neon-safari design on Albuquerque's Route 66.

Price indicative: \$95–\$145/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

17. EL REY COURT

Santa Fe, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1936

A 1936 adobe motor court expanded to 86 rooms during a 2018 renovation that added a mezcal bar, communal hot tubs, and curated Southwest decor. El Rey sits on Cerrillos Road — Santa Fe's Route 66 alignment — and represents the hybridization of motor court nostalgia with contemporary hospitality. The 2018 renovation preserved the original adobe walls and courtyard layout while adding the amenities modern travelers expect.

Why choose it: A 1936 adobe motor court with mezcal bar and hot tubs, on Santa Fe's Route 66 alignment.

Price indicative: \$115–\$175/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

18. EL RANCHO HOTEL

Gallup, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1936

Built in 1936 by R.E. Griffith — brother of film pioneer D.W. Griffith — to house Hollywood actors filming westerns in the New Mexico desert. The lobby displays signed photographs of Ronald Reagan, Kirk Douglas, and Katharine Hepburn, among dozens of others who stayed here. Listed on the National Register, the hotel's two-story log-cabin lobby and rooms named after movie stars make it a living archive of Hollywood's Route 66 era.

Why choose it: A 1936 hotel built for Hollywood actors, with signed portraits of Reagan, Douglas, and Hepburn.

Price indicative: \$95–\$140/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

19. HOTEL BLUE 66, BW SIGNATURE COLLECTION

Santa Rosa, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Santa Rosa's top-rated hotel sits minutes from the Blue Hole — a bell-shaped artesian pool 80 feet deep with water so clear it draws scuba divers from across the Southwest. Route

66-certified, with a pool, hot tub, and free breakfast. Santa Rosa also houses the Route 66 Auto Museum, a collection of pre-1966 automobiles displayed in a former car dealership. A practical midpoint between Tucumcari and Albuquerque.

Why choose it: Route 66-certified hotel near the Blue Hole, a crystal-clear 80-foot diving pool.

Price indicative: \$100–\$140/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Arizona

Arizona packs Route 66's most dramatic scenery: painted deserts, ponderosa forests, the Grand Canyon's gateway, and a string of small towns that fought to keep the road alive.

20. AMERICANA MOTOR HOTEL

Flagstaff, AZ | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1962

Built in 1962 and reopened in 2023 after a ground-up renovation that earned it Motel of the Year 2024 from a Route 66 preservation organization. Heated pool, fire pits, and a design that honors mid-century motor hotel architecture while delivering contemporary comfort. Located on Route 66 through Flagstaff, at the base of the San Francisco Peaks. The Grand Canyon South Rim is 80 miles north.

Why choose it: 2024 Motel of the Year, a 1962 motor hotel reborn with heated pool and fire pits.

Price indicative: \$95–\$155/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

21. HISTORIC GRAND CANYON HOTEL

Williams, AZ | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1891

Opened in 1891 — predating Route 66 by 35 years — this is the oldest hotel in northern Arizona. Over 1,300 TripAdvisor reviews confirm consistent quality in a building that has survived fires, economic depressions, and the interstate highway system. Williams is the Grand Canyon Railway departure town, and this hotel sits on its Route 66 main street. The building's Victorian proportions and wooden staircase are original.

Why choose it: Northern Arizona's oldest hotel (1891), on the main street of the Grand Canyon Railway town.

Price indicative: \$90–\$135/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

22. THE LODGE ON ROUTE 66

Williams, AZ | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1930

A restored 1930s motor lodge in Williams with free breakfast and a location directly on Route 66. The restoration preserved the original lodge footprint — low-slung buildings arranged around a central parking area — while adding insulation, modern plumbing, and updated

furnishings. Williams' walkable downtown offers vintage diners and the Grand Canyon Railway depot, both within 10 minutes on foot.

Why choose it: A restored 1930s motor lodge with free breakfast, walking distance to the Grand Canyon Railway.

Price indicative: \$93–\$145/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

23. BEST WESTERN PLUS KING'S INN & SUITES

Kingman, AZ | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.4/5

Kingman's second-ranked hotel by guest reviews (1,993 on TripAdvisor, 4.5 location rating), positioned where Route 66 reaches its westernmost Arizona point before descending into the California desert. The Route 66 Museum at the Powerhouse Visitor Center is a 5-minute drive. From Kingman, the pre-interstate Route 66 alignment over Sitgreaves Pass to Oatman is one of the most dramatic driving segments on the entire Mother Road.

Why choose it: Top-rated Kingman hotel near the Route 66 Museum and the dramatic Oatman mountain pass.

Price indicative: \$95–\$130/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

24. BEST WESTERN PLUS A WAYFARER'S INN

Kingman, AZ | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Kingman's top-ranked hotel on TripAdvisor, a AAA Three Diamond property with consistent quality. Positioned as a practical base for drivers planning the Oatman detour — a winding mountain road through Gold Rush country that rejoins I-40 near Topock. The detour adds 25 miles but delivers burros wandering Main Street and dollar-bill-wallpapered saloons. This hotel handles the logistics before and after.

Why choose it: AAA Three Diamond hotel in the jump-off town for the Oatman Gold Rush detour.

Price indicative: \$95–\$125/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

California

The final stretch crosses the Mojave Desert, climbs the Cajon Pass, and descends through the Los Angeles basin to the Pacific Ocean at Santa Monica Pier.

25. HAMPTON INN NEEDLES

Needles, CA | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

The top-rated hotel in Needles, a desert town that recorded 127°F in 2024. Free hot breakfast and a pool are essential, not optional, at this latitude. Needles sits on the California border where Route 66 travelers would have stopped for the state's agricultural inspection station — a

moment captured in *The Grapes of Wrath*. The Mojave Desert stretches 150 miles west to Barstow.

Why choose it: Best-rated property in a 127°F desert town with 150 miles of Mojave ahead.

Price indicative: \$95–\$135/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

26. BEST WESTERN COLORADO RIVER INN

Needles, CA | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

A 63-room property with pool, sauna, and hot tub in a town where the Colorado River provides the only relief from Mojave heat. The hotel has operated as a Route 66 landmark since the 1970s, predating the interstate bypass. Needles' former Harvey House — the 1908 El Garces hotel, designed in Greek temple style — stands as a National Register landmark awaiting restoration nearby.

Why choose it: Colorado River access and a pool in the desert, near the 1908 El Garces Harvey House ruins.

Price indicative: \$90–\$125/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

27. SAGA MOTOR HOTEL

Pasadena, CA | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1959

A 1959 Mid-Century Modern motel on Colorado Boulevard — Pasadena's Route 66 alignment and the Tournament of Roses Parade route. The property's original neon sign was designated a local historic landmark in 2002. Rooms have been updated while preserving the single-story motor court layout. Old Town Pasadena's restaurants and shops are walking distance. The Rose Bowl is a 10-minute drive.

Why choose it: A historic-landmark neon sign on the Rose Parade route, in Mid-Century Modern style.

Price indicative: \$135–\$160/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

28. PASADENA HOTEL & POOL

Pasadena, CA | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1926

Built in 1926 — the same year Route 66 was established — this hotel on Colorado Boulevard has operated continuously through the Mother Road's entire existence. A renovated 1920s lobby and bar anchor the property, with rooms updated to contemporary standards. The courtyard pool is a rarity at this price point in Pasadena. The property sits on the Rose Parade route, three miles from the Route 66 endpoint approach.

Why choose it: Continuously operating since Route 66's founding year (1926), with a courtyard pool.

Price indicative: \$120–\$165/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

29. HOLIDAY INN VICTORVILLE

Victorville, CA | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Near the California Route 66 Museum on D Street in Victorville, this property offers free breakfast and a base for exploring the high desert segment of Route 66 through the Cajon Pass — the dramatic mountain descent where the Mother Road drops from 4,200 feet to the Los Angeles basin. The pass was a bottleneck for Dust Bowl migrants and remains one of Route 66's most geologically significant segments.

Why choose it: Base camp for the Cajon Pass, where Route 66 descends from the desert to the LA basin.

Price indicative: \$90–\$135/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

30. OCEAN LODGE HOTEL

Santa Monica, CA | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Steps from Santa Monica Pier — the western terminus of Route 66 where the End of the Trail sign marks 2,400 miles from Chicago. The hotel offers ocean proximity at a price point below Santa Monica's luxury tier. Rooms are modest but functional, and the location is the reason to book: you can walk to the Route 66 endpoint, take the photograph, and return to your room in under 10 minutes.

Why choose it: Walking distance to the Route 66 End of the Trail sign at Santa Monica Pier.

Price indicative: \$160–\$240/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

New Mexico

New Mexico's Route 66 runs through high desert, past Pueblo architecture, and along legendary motel rows. The landscape shifts from plains to mesas to the Rio Grande valley.

31. HAMPTON INN SANTA ROSA

Santa Rosa, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

A practical overnight in Santa Rosa, New Mexico — the midpoint between Tucumcari and Albuquerque where Route 66 crosses the Pecos River. The Blue Hole, a natural artesian spring 80 feet deep with 62°F water, sits two miles from the hotel. The Route 66 Auto Museum displays pre-1966 automobiles in a restored car dealership. Rooms are consistent Hilton-standard with free breakfast.

Why choose it: Midpoint overnight between Tucumcari and Albuquerque, near the 80-foot Blue Hole.

Price indicative: \$90–\$130/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

32. BEST WESTERN PLUS GALLUP INN & SUITES

Gallup, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Gallup — the Indian Capital of the World, per a 1940s tourism campaign — sits at the intersection of Route 66 and the Navajo Nation. This top-rated Best Western offers modern amenities and free breakfast in a town known for its turquoise jewelry trading posts and the annual Inter-Tribal Indian Ceremonial, held since 1922. Richardson's Trading Post, one of the oldest in the Southwest, is nearby.

Why choose it: Top-rated Gallup hotel at the crossroads of Route 66 and Navajo Nation trading post country.

Price indicative: \$90–\$125/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

33. SPRINGHILL SUITES GALLUP

Gallup, NM | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

An all-suite Marriott property in Gallup offering larger rooms than standard hotels — useful for families on multi-week Route 66 drives. Studio suites include a pullout sofa and mini-fridge. Gallup's Route 66 alignment through Coal Avenue features a dozen murals depicting the town's railroad and Native American heritage. The Navajo Code Talkers museum is a 10-minute drive.

Why choose it: All-suite rooms in Gallup, with space for Route 66 road-trip families.

Price indicative: \$95–\$130/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Arizona

Arizona packs Route 66's most dramatic scenery: painted deserts, ponderosa forests, the Grand Canyon's gateway, and a string of small towns that fought to keep the road alive.

34. BEST WESTERN PLUS INN OF WILLIAMS

Williams, AZ | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Ranked among Williams' top five hotels with 2,534 TripAdvisor reviews, this property serves as a reliable base for Grand Canyon excursions. The Grand Canyon Railway departs from Williams depot at 9:30 AM daily for a 2-hour, 15-minute journey to the South Rim. The hotel's location off Route 66 provides easy access to both the railway and Williams' walkable vintage downtown.

Why choose it: Reliable base for Grand Canyon Railway trips from Williams' Route 66 depot.

Price indicative: \$100–\$145/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

35. LA QUINTA INN & SUITES KINGMAN

Kingman, AZ | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5

An 8.5/10-rated property in Kingman with 2,475 reviews, consistently praised for value. Kingman is the final Arizona town on Route 66 before the California border, and from here drivers face a choice: the interstate to Needles or the pre-highway alignment through Oatman's Gold Rush ghost town. Either way, the Mojave Desert begins. This hotel provides the last comfortable overnight before the crossing.

Why choose it: Highest-reviewed value hotel at Route 66's last Arizona stop before the Mojave.

Price indicative: \$90–\$120/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Texas

The Texas Panhandle delivers the flattest, most unbroken horizon on Route 66. Cadillac Ranch, the Big Texan, and the open road itself are the main attractions.

36. DRURY INN & SUITES AMARILLO

Amarillo, TX | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Drury's signature free evening kickback — hot food and three alcoholic drinks — effectively eliminates your dinner bill in a city where steak restaurants are the primary option. Located near both Cadillac Ranch (the iconic art installation of 10 half-buried Cadillacs) and the Route 66 Historic District on 6th Avenue. The savings over dinner out can fund a full extra night on the road.

Why choose it: Free dinner and drinks near Cadillac Ranch — your meal budget stays in your tank.

Price indicative: \$100–\$150/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

37. RESIDENCE INN OKLAHOMA CITY NORTHWEST

Oklahoma City, OK | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★ 4.1/5

Extended-stay rooms with full kitchens offer Route 66 road-trippers a chance to cook their own meals after days of diner food. A daily breakfast buffet supplements the kitchen. Oklahoma City's Route 66 alignment runs through the city center, past the Gold Dome building — a 1958 Buckminster Fuller geodesic dome that has become OKC's most recognizable Route 66 landmark.

Why choose it: Full kitchens for cooking after days of diner food, on OKC's Route 66 alignment.

Price indicative: \$105–\$140/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Missouri

Missouri offers 300 miles of continuous Route 66 driving through the Ozarks, with some of the road's best-preserved motor courts and cave attractions along the way.

38. LE MÉRIDIDIEN ST. LOUIS DOWNTOWN

Saint Louis, MO | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1913

Originally built in 1913-1914 as the Majestic Hotel, this downtown St. Louis property has been restored and rebranded as a Le Méridien. The original facade and lobby proportions survive, placing it among the oldest operating hotels in the city. The Gateway Arch is a 10-minute walk. Route 66 passed through downtown St. Louis before crossing the Chain of Rocks Bridge over the Mississippi.

Why choose it: A 1913 hotel restoration in downtown St. Louis, 10 minutes from the Gateway Arch.

Price indicative: \$110–\$160/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Illinois

The Mother Road begins in Chicago's Grant Park and cuts southwest through the prairie, passing diners, drive-ins, and small towns where Route 66 memorabilia fills every storefront.

39. PRESIDENT ABRAHAM LINCOLN SPRINGFIELD

Springfield, IL | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★☆ 4.1/5

A 310-room DoubleTree property in historic downtown Springfield, connected to the convention center and within walking distance of the Lincoln Home National Historic Site. The hotel functions as Springfield's primary full-service property, with an on-site restaurant and lobby bar. Abraham Lincoln's law office, tomb, and presidential museum are all within a 2-mile radius.

Why choose it: Full-service hotel in Lincoln's hometown, walking distance to the Lincoln Home.

Price indicative: \$90–\$135/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

California

The final stretch crosses the Mojave Desert, climbs the Cajon Pass, and descends through the Los Angeles basin to the Pacific Ocean at Santa Monica Pier.

40. WIGWAM MOTEL

Rialto/San Bernardino, CA | [MID-RANGE] | ★★★★★☆ 4/5 | Est. 1949

Wigwam Village #7 on Foothill Boulevard — Route 66's alignment through San Bernardino — consists of 19 concrete teepees standing 32 feet high, built in 1949. Listed on the National Register of Historic Places since 2012. Unlike the Holbrook Wigwam, this location sits in the Los Angeles metropolitan area, making it the last piece of kitsch Route 66 architecture before the road reaches Santa Monica. Original furniture survives in several rooms.

Why choose it: The last Wigwam Village on Route 66, 60 miles from the end of the road at Santa Monica.

Price indicative: \$100–\$140/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Luxury Tier: 40 Hotels (\$180+/night)

Illinois

The Mother Road begins in Chicago's Grant Park and cuts southwest through the prairie, passing diners, drive-ins, and small towns where Route 66 memorabilia fills every storefront.

1. PALMER HOUSE, A HILTON HOTEL

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.4/5 | Est. 1871

Founded in 1871 and rebuilt after the Great Chicago Fire, the Palmer House is the longest continuously operating hotel in North America. The lobby ceiling — a series of 21 paintings by Louis Pierre Rigal — is one of the most photographed hotel interiors in America. Route 66 begins at Grant Park, a 7-minute walk east. 1,641 rooms across 24 floors, with the Empire Room ballroom hosting every U.S. president since Grant.

Why choose it: America's longest continuously operating hotel, a 7-minute walk from Route 66's starting point.

Price indicative: \$185–\$350/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

2. CONGRESS PLAZA HOTEL

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.2/5 | Est. 1893

Built for the 1893 World's Columbian Exposition and standing directly across Michigan Avenue from Grant Park — the exact starting point of Route 66. This is the closest hotel to Mile Zero. Presidents Theodore Roosevelt, William Taft, and Grover Cleveland all stayed here. The Beaux-Arts facade and 871 rooms have witnessed 130 years of Chicago history. A documented starting point for Mother Road departures.

Why choose it: The closest hotel to Route 66's Mile Zero at Grant Park, open since the 1893 World's Fair.

Price indicative: \$180–\$280/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

3. INTERCONTINENTAL CHICAGO MAGNIFICENT MILE

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1929

Built in 1929 as the Medina Athletic Club, this hotel preserves a jazz-era indoor swimming pool with gold-leaf ceiling that National Geographic identified as one of the world's most notable hotel pools. The building's Moorish-influenced exterior and limestone detailing date to the same decade Route 66 was established. 792 rooms across two towers, on the Magnificent Mile.

Why choose it: A 1929 jazz-era hotel with a gold-leaf swimming pool cited by National Geographic.

Price indicative: \$200–\$380/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

4. CHICAGO ATHLETIC ASSOCIATION

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1893

A Venetian Gothic building from 1893, converted to a 240-room boutique hotel and designated a MICHELIN Key property. The building's original gymnasium is now a game room with shuffleboard and bocce. Cindy's rooftop restaurant overlooks Millennium Park and Grant Park — where Route 66 begins. The architectural detail per square foot exceeds most Chicago hotels twice its price.

Why choose it: A MICHELIN Key hotel in an 1893 Venetian Gothic building overlooking Route 66's origin point.

Price indicative: \$195–\$350/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Missouri

Missouri offers 300 miles of continuous Route 66 driving through the Ozarks, with some of the road's best-preserved motor courts and cave attractions along the way.

5. FOUR SEASONS HOTEL ST. LOUIS

Saint Louis, MO | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.8/5

Overlooking the Mississippi River with direct views of the Gateway Arch, this Forbes Four Star property is St. Louis's most awarded hotel. A Gordon Ramsay restaurant anchors the dining program. Route 66 crossed the Mississippi here via the Chain of Rocks Bridge — a 1929 structure now open as a pedestrian path. The hotel's position marks the geographic and psychological transition from the Midwest to the West.

Why choose it: Forbes Four Star hotel facing the Gateway Arch, where Route 66 crosses the Mississippi.

Price indicative: \$300–\$500/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

6. THE ROYAL SONESTA CHASE PARK PLAZA

Saint Louis, MO | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.4/5 | Est. 1922

Built in 1922 in Italian Renaissance style and inducted into Historic Hotels of America in 2025. Three restaurants, a rooftop pool, and 390 rooms in the Central West End neighborhood. The building's terracotta facade and lobby detailing represent the architectural ambition of 1920s St. Louis — a city that was America's fourth-largest when Route 66 was established. Forest Park's free museums are walking distance.

Why choose it: A 1922 Italian Renaissance hotel, newly inducted into Historic Hotels of America.

Price indicative: \$180–\$300/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

7. MARRIOTT ST. LOUIS GRAND HOTEL

Saint Louis, MO | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5 | Est. 1917

Originally the 1917 Hotel Statler on Washington Avenue — St. Louis's historic commercial spine — this property underwent a \$30 million renovation that preserved original marble lobby details and brass elevator doors. The Washington Avenue Historic District, now an entertainment corridor, was once the center of the garment industry. The hotel's 1917 origins predate Route 66 by nine years.

Why choose it: A \$30 million renovation of a 1917 hotel on St. Louis's historic Washington Avenue.

Price indicative: \$150–\$250/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

8. AMBASSADOR HOTEL TULSA, AUTOGRAPH COLLECTION

Tulsa, OK | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.6/5 | Est. 1929

A 1929 Art Deco hotel built during Tulsa's oil boom, when the city was the Oil Capital of the World and Route 66 was its main commercial artery. Fifty-five rooms feature Mediterranean-style details and period proportions. Listed on the National Register, the building's terra cotta ornamentation and marble lobby represent the peak of Tulsa's petroleum wealth. The Chalkboard restaurant serves farm-to-table Oklahoma cuisine.

Why choose it: Tulsa's finest Art Deco hotel from the Oil Capital era, on the National Register.

Price indicative: \$200–\$400/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

9. THE SKIRVIN OKLAHOMA CITY, A HILTON HOTEL

Oklahoma City, OK | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5 | Est. 1911

Opened in 1911 by oilman W.B. Skirvin and listed on the National Register, this hotel predates Route 66 by 15 years and served as Oklahoma City's social center throughout the Mother Road's golden era. A \$22 million renovation completed in 2025 refreshed all 225 rooms while preserving the original marble floors and brass details. NBA teams stay here during Oklahoma City games — and some players have reported ghost sightings.

Why choose it: A 1911 National Register landmark with a \$22 million 2025 renovation and NBA ghost stories.

Price indicative: \$180–\$300/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

10. COLCORD HOTEL, CURIO COLLECTION BY HILTON

Oklahoma City, OK | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.7/5 | Est. 1910

Built in 1910 as Oklahoma City's first skyscraper and listed on the National Register, the Colcord was converted to a boutique hotel that has earned a 9.4/10 guest rating — the highest of any hotel in the city. Original marble staircases, vintage tile work, and period detailing survive throughout. Historic Hotels of America member. The building's pre-statehood origins (Oklahoma became a state in 1907) give it unique architectural provenance.

Why choose it: OKC's first skyscraper (1910), now its highest-rated boutique hotel at 9.4/10.

Price indicative: \$185–\$300/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

11. THE NATIONAL OKLAHOMA CITY, AUTOGRAPH COLLECTION

Oklahoma City, OK | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.4/5 | Est. 1931

The 1931 First National Bank tower — once Oklahoma's tallest building — was converted to a 146-room hotel in 2022 with a speakeasy bar in the original vault, four restaurants, and period details from the banking era. The building's Art Deco elevator doors, marble counters, and brass fixtures survived the conversion. Listed on the National Register. The Automobile Alley Arts District is walking distance.

Why choose it: A 1931 bank vault converted to a speakeasy, in Oklahoma's former tallest building.

Price indicative: \$210–\$350/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Texas

The Texas Panhandle delivers the flattest, most unbroken horizon on Route 66. Cadillac Ranch, the Big Texan, and the open road itself are the main attractions.

12. THE BARFIELD, AUTOGRAPH COLLECTION

Amarillo, TX | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.7/5

Amarillo's only true luxury hotel, occupying a historic downtown building with a 9.4/10 guest rating and an on-site Toscana steakhouse. The property fills a gap that Route 66 travelers have noted for decades — Amarillo's hospitality scene was almost entirely mid-range until this hotel arrived. The Barfield's existence signals Amarillo's evolution from cattle town to a destination with editorial-quality dining and lodging.

Why choose it: The Texas Panhandle's first luxury hotel, filling a decades-long gap on Route 66.

Price indicative: \$195–\$320/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

New Mexico

New Mexico's Route 66 runs through high desert, past Pueblo architecture, and along legendary motel rows. The landscape shifts from plains to mesas to the Rio Grande valley.

13. LA FONDA ON THE PLAZA

Santa Fe, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1922

A Historic Hotels of America member rebuilt in 1922 on a site that has hosted an inn since 1607 — making it the oldest hotel location in the United States. Pueblo Revival architecture, hand-painted headboards, and a rooftop bar with Sangre de Cristo mountain views. Santa Fe's pre-1937 Route 66 alignment passed through the Plaza, and this hotel anchored the commercial center. La Plazuela restaurant serves New Mexican cuisine beneath a skylight.

Why choose it: The oldest hotel site in America (1607), a Historic Hotels member on the Santa Fe Plaza.

Price indicative: \$200–\$450/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

14. INN OF THE FIVE GRACES

Santa Fe, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 5/5

A Relais & Châteaux property rated the #1 hotel in Santa Fe by Travel + Leisure for three consecutive years. Hand-crafted tilework, Tibetan textiles, and kiva fireplaces in every suite create a maximalist Southwest aesthetic. Twenty-four suites occupy a compound of restored adobe buildings near the Plaza. Route 66's pre-1937 alignment ran through Santa Fe before being realigned south to Albuquerque.

Why choose it: Relais & Châteaux and Travel + Leisure's #1 Santa Fe hotel for three consecutive years.

Price indicative: \$700–\$1200/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

15. HOTEL CHACO

Albuquerque, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5

An AAA Four Diamond hotel inspired by Chaco Canyon's ancestral Puebloan architecture, with contemporary Native American art throughout. The Level 5 rooftop restaurant offers panoramic views of the Sandia Mountains. Located in Albuquerque's Old Town area, a 10-minute drive from Central Avenue's Route 66 alignment. The hotel partners with Native artisans for in-room and public-space installations.

Why choose it: AAA Four Diamond hotel with rooftop Sandia Mountain views and Native American art program.

Price indicative: \$230–\$400/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

16. HOTEL PARQ CENTRAL

Albuquerque, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1926

Built in 1926 as the Santa Fe Railway Hospital and listed on the National Register, this property was converted to a boutique hotel with a rooftop lounge offering 360-degree views of Albuquerque — the Sandias to the east, the Rio Grande valley to the west. Original hospital-era details survive in the hallways and lobby. The building served railroad workers during Route 66's earliest years.

Why choose it: A 1926 railway hospital turned rooftop-lounge hotel, with 360-degree Albuquerque views.

Price indicative: \$180–\$280/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

17. ARRIVE ALBUQUERQUE

Albuquerque, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Opened in 2025 as a full restoration of a Route 66 landmark motel on Central Avenue, ARRIVE features a Zia-shaped pool, a Secret Gallery showcasing Native American artists, and design details that reference the Mother Road without resorting to nostalgia. The property represents the next generation of Route 66 hospitality — historically aware, design-forward, and operationally modern.

Why choose it: A 2025 Route 66 landmark restoration with Zia pool and Native American artist gallery.

Price indicative: \$180–\$280/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

18. BOTTGER MANSION OF OLD TOWN

Albuquerque, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5 | Est. 1912

A 1912 mansion in Albuquerque's Old Town, converted to a bed and breakfast with rooms named after New Mexico's cultural traditions. Award-winning breakfast served in a courtyard garden. The building predates Route 66 by 14 years and sits in the city's oldest neighborhood — founded in 1706. The property's scale is intimate: seven rooms, personal service, and a pace that contrasts with the road.

Why choose it: A 1912 Old Town mansion B&B with award-winning breakfast and seven intimate rooms.

Price indicative: \$180–\$250/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Arizona

Arizona packs Route 66's most dramatic scenery: painted deserts, ponderosa forests, the Grand Canyon's gateway, and a string of small towns that fought to keep the road alive.

19. LA POSADA HOTEL

Winslow, AZ | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5 | Est. 1930

Designed in 1930 by Mary Colter — the architect behind Grand Canyon's Bright Angel Lodge and Hopi House — for the Fred Harvey Company, La Posada was the last of the great Harvey House railroad hotels. Rescued from demolition in 1997 and painstakingly restored, it is the only hotel in America with an active Amtrak stop. The Turquoise Room restaurant is considered the finest dining between Albuquerque and Flagstaff. Historic Hotels of America member.

Why choose it: Mary Colter's last great Harvey House, the only US hotel with an active Amtrak platform.

Price indicative: \$185–\$300/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

20. L'AUBERGE DE SEDONA

Sedona, AZ | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 5/5

A Small Luxury Hotels of the World member, rated Condé Nast Traveler's #1 hotel in the American Southwest. Creekside cottages sit beneath red-rock formations 30 miles south of Flagstaff — a short detour from Route 66 through Oak Creek Canyon, one of Arizona's most scenic drives. Award-winning spa, fine dining at Etch Kitchen & Bar, and a setting that has no equivalent on the Route 66 corridor.

Why choose it: Condé Nast Traveler's #1 Southwest hotel, a 30-mile detour from Route 66 through Sedona.

Price indicative: \$450–\$900/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

21. HILTON SEDONA RESORT AT BELL ROCK

Sedona, AZ | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5

A 221-room full-service resort with spa, championship golf course carved into red-rock terrain, and views of Bell Rock — one of Sedona's famous vortex sites. Sedona sits 30 miles south of Flagstaff via Arizona 89A through Oak Creek Canyon. The detour from Route 66 takes 45 minutes and delivers some of the most dramatic landscape in the American West. Pools, tennis courts, and multiple dining options on-site.

Why choose it: Full-service resort with red-rock golf, 45 minutes from Flagstaff's Route 66 corridor.

Price indicative: \$210–\$450/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

22. THE WILDE RESORT AND SPA

Sedona, AZ | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5

A boutique resort focused on Sedona's vortex culture, with guided meditation sessions, desert spa treatments, and Verde Valley cuisine. The property sits among red-rock formations visible

from every room. For Route 66 travelers who have spent days on flat highways through Oklahoma and Texas, Sedona's vertical landscape is a visceral shift. The resort represents the kind of restorative detour that transforms a road trip.

Why choose it: Vortex-focused desert spa resort, a restorative detour from the flat-highway grind.

Price indicative: \$350–\$600/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

California

The final stretch crosses the Mojave Desert, climbs the Cajon Pass, and descends through the Los Angeles basin to the Pacific Ocean at Santa Monica Pier.

23. THE LANGHAM HUNTINGTON

Pasadena, CA | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1914

Opened in 1914 on 23 acres in Pasadena and named one of USA Today's Top 10 Historic Hotels. The Langham sits near Colorado Boulevard — Route 66's alignment through Pasadena and the Rose Parade route. An award-winning Chuan Spa, 379 rooms, and century-old ballrooms have hosted celebrities, presidents, and film productions. The San Gabriel Mountains form the backdrop to the hotel's gardens.

Why choose it: A 1914 resort on 23 acres near Route 66's Rose Parade alignment, with century-old ballrooms.

Price indicative: \$280–\$500/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

24. AC HOTEL PASADENA

Pasadena, CA | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5

A 194-room European-influenced hotel in Playhouse Village, one block from Colorado Boulevard. The AC brand emphasizes clean design and curated public spaces — a counter-narrative to the vintage motor courts that define most of Route 66. Restaurants and a rooftop bar serve as a social hub for Pasadena's young professional crowd. The Rose Bowl is a 10-minute drive through the Arroyo Seco.

Why choose it: European-design hotel one block from Route 66's Colorado Boulevard in Pasadena.

Price indicative: \$180–\$275/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

25. HOTEL CASA DEL MAR

Santa Monica, CA | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1926

Built in 1926 — Route 66's founding year — as a Mediterranean Revival beach club, Casa del Mar celebrates its centennial in 2026. The 129-room hotel stands on the sand in Santa Monica, less than a mile from the Route 66 End of the Trail sign on the pier. A private beach club

heritage, Forbes Five Star rating, and original architectural details make it the most distinguished property at the road's western terminus.

Why choose it: The centennial hotel (1926-2026) at Route 66's western terminus, with Forbes Five Star rating.

Price indicative: \$400–\$850/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

26. THE GEORGIAN HOTEL

Santa Monica, CA | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5 | Est. 1933

An eight-story Art Deco tower built in 1933 on Ocean Avenue — Santa Monica's front row — with direct ocean views from upper floors. The Georgian was Santa Monica's first skyscraper and a fixture of Hollywood's Golden Age, when stars would drive Route 66 in reverse from the beach to weekend ranches in Arizona. Speakeasy-era details survive in the lobby and restaurant.

Why choose it: Santa Monica's first skyscraper (1933), an Art Deco ocean-view icon from the speakeasy era.

Price indicative: \$300–\$600/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

27. FAIRMONT MIRAMAR HOTEL & BUNGALOWS

Santa Monica, CA | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1921

Originally a senator's mansion dating to 1889, the Miramar was converted to a hotel in 1921 and expanded around a giant Moreton Bay fig tree that still anchors the property. Five-star oceanfront setting, private bungalows, and a location on Wilshire Boulevard — one mile from Route 66's endpoint. The tree, planted in 1889, is one of Santa Monica's most significant living landmarks.

Why choose it: A senator's 1889 mansion turned five-star oceanfront hotel, anchored by a landmark fig tree.

Price indicative: \$350–\$700/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

28. SANTA MONICA PROPER HOTEL

Santa Monica, CA | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5

A Kelly Wearstler-designed boutique hotel that represents the contemporary end of Santa Monica's hospitality spectrum. Rooftop pool, Mediterranean restaurant, and design details that reference California's mid-century heritage without mimicking it. Located on Wilshire Boulevard, a short walk from the pier and the Route 66 endpoint. The design contrasts sharply with the vintage motor courts 2,400 miles behind you.

Why choose it: Kelly Wearstler-designed boutique at Route 66's end, a stylistic bookend to the journey.

Price indicative: \$280–\$500/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Illinois

The Mother Road begins in Chicago's Grant Park and cuts southwest through the prairie, passing diners, drive-ins, and small towns where Route 66 memorabilia fills every storefront.

29. THE DRAKE HOTEL

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1920

A National Historic Landmark since its 1920 opening, the Drake commands the northern tip of Michigan Avenue where the Magnificent Mile meets Lake Michigan. The Palm Court lobby and Cape Cod Room restaurant have served Chicago's social elite for over a century. Route 66's starting point at Grant Park is 1.5 miles south. The hotel's limestone facade and Italian Renaissance detailing are landmarks of the Chicago skyline.

Why choose it: A 1920 National Historic Landmark on the Magnificent Mile, 1.5 miles from Route 66's start.

Price indicative: \$250–\$500/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

30. SILVERSMITH HOTEL CHICAGO DOWNTOWN

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.3/5 | Est. 1897

Built in 1897 in what was then Chicago's Jewelers Row, this 143-room hotel preserves 12-foot ceilings, marble bathrooms, and architectural details from the Gilded Age. The building's narrow facade and ornate cornice are visible from the Chicago Architecture Center's boat tour on the river. Located in the Loop, within walking distance of Grant Park and the Route 66 departure point.

Why choose it: Gilded Age hotel with 12-foot ceilings in Jewelers Row, walking distance to Route 66's start.

Price indicative: \$130–\$220/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

31. RENAISSANCE OKLAHOMA CITY DOWNTOWN BRICKTOWN

Oklahoma City, OK | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.2/5

A full-service hotel in Bricktown — Oklahoma City's converted warehouse entertainment district along the Bricktown Canal. On-site dining, a pool, and proximity to the Oklahoma City National Memorial (the 1995 bombing site, now a museum and reflection pool) distinguish it from chain alternatives. Route 66 runs through downtown OKC, and the National Cowboy & Western Heritage Museum is a 10-minute drive.

Why choose it: Full-service hotel in OKC's warehouse-to-canal entertainment district, near the National Memorial.

Price indicative: \$180–\$280/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Arizona

Arizona packs Route 66's most dramatic scenery: painted deserts, ponderosa forests, the Grand Canyon's gateway, and a string of small towns that fought to keep the road alive.

32. ARIZONA BILTMORE, LXR HOTELS & RESORTS

Phoenix, AZ | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1929

Opened in 1929 with architecture influenced by Frank Lloyd Wright — who served as a consulting architect — the Biltmore has hosted every U.S. president since Herbert Hoover. Seven pools, AAA Four Diamond designation held for over seven years, and 39 acres of gardens in the Sonoran Desert. Phoenix sits 150 miles south of Flagstaff; the detour adds a day but delivers one of America's most architecturally significant resort properties.

Why choose it: Frank Lloyd Wright-influenced 1929 resort where every president since Hoover has stayed.

Price indicative: \$250–\$500/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

New Mexico

New Mexico's Route 66 runs through high desert, past Pueblo architecture, and along legendary motel rows. The landscape shifts from plains to mesas to the Rio Grande valley.

33. DRURY PLAZA HOTEL SANTA FE

Santa Fe, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5

Occupying a historic building near the Santa Fe Plaza, this Drury property offers the chain's signature free evening kickback (hot food and drinks) in a city where dinner prices regularly exceed \$40 per person. The economic math is compelling: luxury-adjacent comfort with \$50+ in daily food savings. Santa Fe's Route 66 alignment ran through the Plaza until the 1937 realignment shifted traffic south.

Why choose it: Free evening food and drinks in a \$40-dinner city, near the historic Route 66 Plaza.

Price indicative: \$180–\$280/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

34. LOS POBLANOS HISTORIC INN & ORGANIC FARM

Albuquerque, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.8/5 | Est. 1932

A 1932 estate converted to a farm-stay inn on 25 acres of organic lavender fields in Albuquerque's North Valley. Rooms occupy the original ranch house and a restored dairy barn. Farm-to-table breakfast uses produce from the property. The lavender distillery produces oils and soaps sold in an on-site shop. This is the most editorially distinctive lodging in greater Albuquerque — a working agricultural property with genuine luxury.

Why choose it: A 25-acre organic lavender farm-stay with on-site distillery, Albuquerque's most unique lodge.

Price indicative: \$250–\$450/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

35. TULSA CLUB HOTEL, CURIO COLLECTION

Tulsa, OK | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.5/5 | Est. 1927

Built in 1927 as Tulsa's premier social club during the oil boom, designed by architect Bruce Goff in an Art Deco style that reflected the city's petroleum wealth. The building was converted to a 96-room hotel preserving original terrazzo floors, ornate elevator doors, and a ballroom with 30-foot ceilings. Located downtown, a 10-minute drive from Tulsa's Route 66 alignment on 11th Street. The rooftop bar offers views of the Art Deco skyline.

Why choose it: A 1927 oil-boom social club by architect Bruce Goff, with original terrazzo and a rooftop bar.

Price indicative: \$180–\$300/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Missouri

Missouri offers 300 miles of continuous Route 66 driving through the Ozarks, with some of the road's best-preserved motor courts and cave attractions along the way.

36. HOTELUMIERE AT THE ARCH

Saint Louis, MO | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.2/5

A 294-room all-suite property with direct proximity to the Gateway Arch — the 630-foot stainless steel monument that defines St. Louis's skyline and marks the symbolic western frontier. All rooms are suites with separate living areas. The hotel's connection to Lumiere Place provides dining options. Route 66 crossed the Mississippi at the nearby Chain of Rocks Bridge, now a pedestrian landmark.

Why choose it: All-suite hotel at the foot of the 630-foot Gateway Arch, near Route 66's Mississippi crossing.

Price indicative: \$180–\$280/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

Illinois

The Mother Road begins in Chicago's Grant Park and cuts southwest through the prairie, passing diners, drive-ins, and small towns where Route 66 memorabilia fills every storefront.

37. SWISSÔTEL CHICAGO

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5

A 662-room tower overlooking the Chicago River and Lake Michigan, with European-style service and a spa program. The triangular building's glass curtain wall captures panoramic views of the Chicago skyline from upper floors. Located on the Riverwalk, a 15-minute walk from Grant Park and Route 66's origin. The hotel's Swiss hospitality standards provide a contrast to Chicago's brash American hotel scene.

Why choose it: European-standard service with panoramic Chicago River views, 15 minutes from Route 66's start.

Price indicative: \$185–\$350/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

38. W CHICAGO - LAKESHORE

Chicago, IL | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.2/5

A 33-story lakefront hotel at the edge of the Magnificent Mile with direct Lake Michigan views, an indoor pool, and the CURRENT restaurant. The W brand's contemporary design language provides a sharp departure from Chicago's historic hotels — useful for travelers who want luxury without patina. Navy Pier is adjacent, and Grant Park (Route 66 Mile Zero) is a 20-minute walk south along the lakefront.

Why choose it: 33-story lakefront luxury with Lake Michigan views and a 20-minute walk to Mile Zero.

Price indicative: \$200–\$380/night (2026)

→ [Open in Google Maps](#)

New Mexico

New Mexico's Route 66 runs through high desert, past Pueblo architecture, and along legendary motel rows. The landscape shifts from plains to mesas to the Rio Grande valley.

39. BEST WESTERN PLUS RIO GRANDE INN

Albuquerque, NM | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4/5

Ranked among Albuquerque's top 15 hotels with an 8.7/10 rating from U.S. News, this property sits near Old Town — the city's 1706 original settlement and a walkable district of galleries, restaurants, and the Albuquerque Museum. Central Avenue, the Route 66 alignment, runs one block south. The hotel offers a heated outdoor pool and a location that bridges Old Town's historic character with the Nob Hill dining district to the east.

Why choose it: Top-15 Albuquerque hotel bridging Old Town and the Route 66 Nob Hill dining corridor.

Price indicative: \$130–\$195/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Oklahoma

Oklahoma claims more drivable miles of Route 66 than any other state. Tulsa's Art Deco district and a string of small towns between OKC and the Texas border define this stretch.

40. HYATT REGENCY TULSA DOWNTOWN

Tulsa, OK | [LUXURY] | ★★★★★ 4.2/5

A 454-room full-service hotel in downtown Tulsa with a pool, fitness center, and convention facilities. Tulsa's Art Deco skyline — visible from upper floors — was built during the 1920s oil boom when the city bankrolled extravagant commercial buildings. The Blue Dome District, Cain's Ballroom, and the Philbrook Museum of Art (a 1927 Italianate villa housing a nationally recognized collection) are all within a 10-minute drive.

Why choose it: Full-service downtown hotel overlooking Tulsa's oil-boom Art Deco skyline.

Price indicative: \$185–\$300/night (2026)

[→ Open in Google Maps](#)

Planning Your Nights

Route 66 covers 2,400 miles across eight states. How you distribute your nights depends on your pace. A 10-day drive averages 240 miles per day — manageable but relentless, with limited time for detours. A 14-day trip drops the average to 170 miles, allowing 3–4 hours of exploration per day. A 21-day journey — our recommended pace — averages 115 miles daily and allows multi-night stays in key cities like Tulsa, Albuquerque, and Flagstaff.

Book your first night (Chicago) and last night (Santa Monica) in advance. Between those anchors, flexibility is your advantage. The Oklahoma-to-New Mexico stretch has the fewest lodging options per mile, so reserve rooms in Tucumcari, Gallup, and Flagstaff during peak season (June–August). The Illinois and Missouri stretches have sufficient supply that walk-in availability is common even in summer.

Cancellation policies vary by property. Chain hotels (Best Western, Hampton Inn, La Quinta) typically allow free cancellation until 24–48 hours before check-in. Independent motels and historic properties often have stricter policies — check before booking. For budget travelers, the savings from booking direct (calling the motel) versus third-party platforms can be 10–15%. For luxury properties, book through the hotel's own site to access member rates and complimentary upgrades.

A practical pattern: two budget nights, one mid-range night, repeat. This keeps a 14-night trip under \$1,500 in accommodation while ensuring periodic comfort upgrades. Or front-load budget nights through Illinois and Missouri (where budget options are strong) and allocate luxury spending to Santa Fe, Sedona, or Santa Monica where the premium properties deliver outsized returns.

About EuropeTrip.us

EuropeTrip.us produces premium road trip field guides for independent travelers. With over 7,000 customers across our catalog, we build guides the way documentaries are made: through primary research, on-the-ground verification, and editorial standards.

Every property in this guide was evaluated against documented criteria, guest ratings, historic verification, editorial mentions, and operational data. We do not accept payment or sponsorship from hotels. Our revenue comes from guide sales, which means our only incentive is accuracy. If a property closes, changes ownership, or drops below our quality threshold, it will be removed in the next edition.

Our Field Guide Series covers routes across the United States, Europe, and Australia. Each guide follows the same methodology: primary research, geographic ordering, three-tier pricing, and documentary-style descriptions. No filler. No sponsored content. No generic AI text.

Browse the full collection at europetrip.us